



PSY 101: Lecture 2

Roots and Perspective

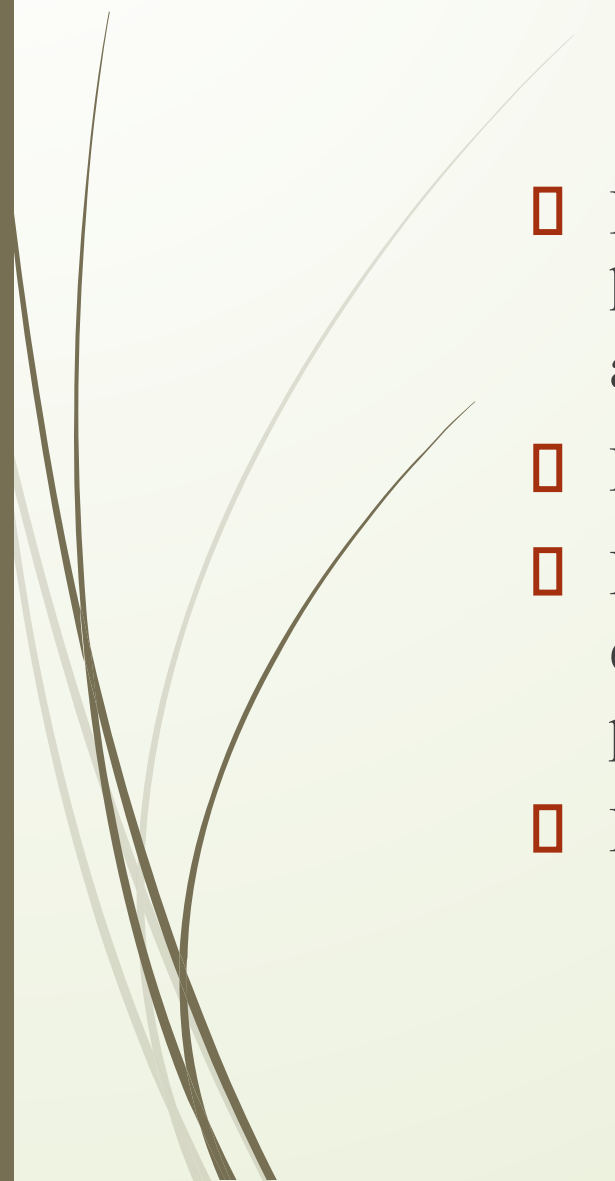
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Learning Objective



- ❑ **Explain** why psychology developed as a scientific discipline and how early thinkers shaped the way psychologists study the mind and behavior.
- ❑ **Describe** the different schools in psychology.
- ❑ **Recognize** that no single psychological perspective can fully explain human behavior, and understand why multiple perspectives are needed.
- ❑ **Describe** different sub-fields in psychology



Schools of Psychology



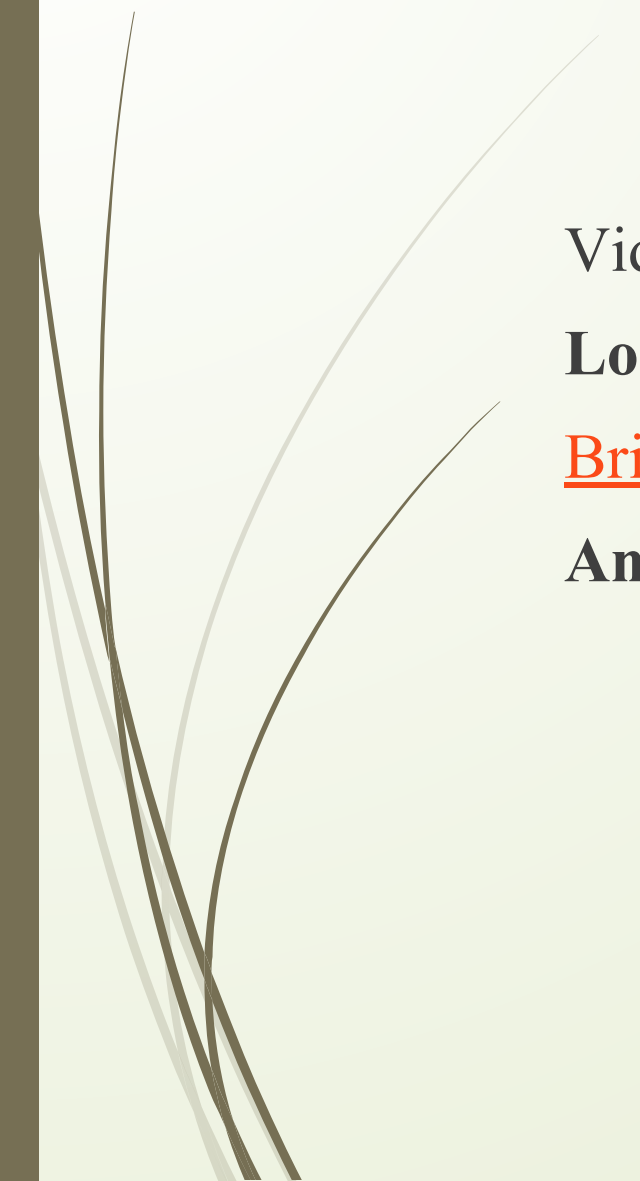
History of Psychology

Video Presentation

Look at the following video

[Brief History of Psychology](#)

And try to answer the given questions





Pop-Up Quiz

True or False? Psychology started from Philosophy

- A. True
- B. False

Who established the first psychology lab?

- C. William James
- D. Wilhelm Wundt
- E. Rene Descartes



Pop-Up Quiz

Who proposed that human characteristics evolved because these were functional?

- A. William James
- B. Wilhelm Wundt
- C. Rene Descartes

Who was the father of Psychoanalysis?

- D. William James
- E. Wilhelm Wundt
- F. Sigmund Freud



Pop-Up Quiz

Freudian Psychoanalysis mainly focused on:

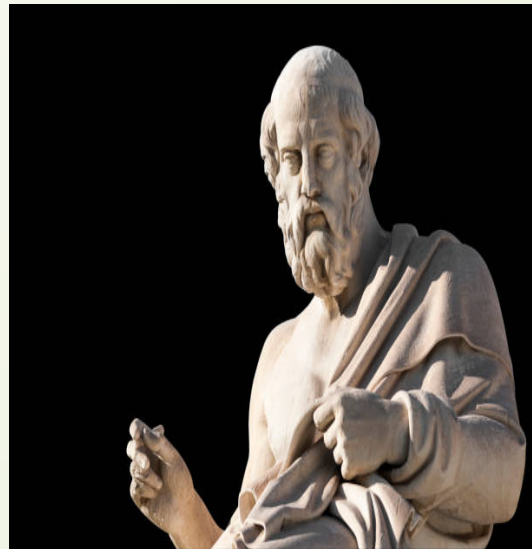
- A. Unconscious mind
- B. Conscious mind

True or False? Freud's idea was not scientific

- C. True
- D. False

Psychology Didn't Start in Labs!

- ▣ *Psychology is a study of behavior (e.g., what we do) and mental processes (e.g., what we think and feel).* Ancient thinkers talked about human mind, memory and learning way before there was any lab.



Plato



Aristotle



Rene Descartes

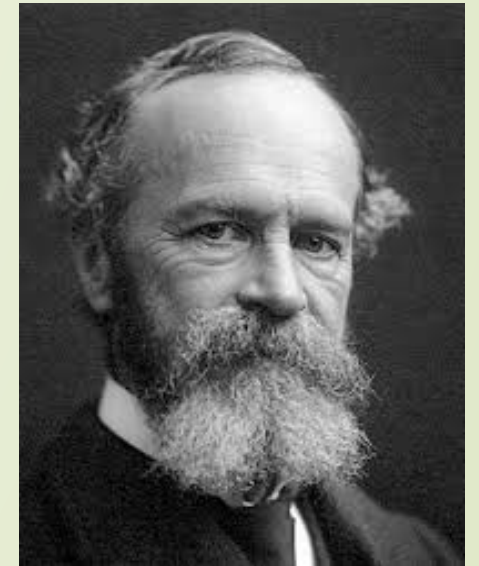
Wilhelm Wundt: Structuralism

- ❑ In **1879**, when **Wilhelm Wundt** opened the **first psychology laboratory** in Leipzig, Germany.
- ❑ In his laboratory, Wundt measured how long it took people to react to sounds, lights, and other stimuli.
- ❑ He was trying to measure the **smallest units of conscious experience**, which he called the “building blocks of the mind.”
- ❑ This moment is considered the **official birth of psychology**.



William James: Functionalism

- ❑ American psychologist named **William James (1870-1890)** was interested to know **What is the mind for?**
- ❑ He believed that our mental processes aren't random, rather these serves a purpose and help us to **adapt and survive.**
- ❑ James's approach became known as **functionalism.**
- ❑ He also believed that consciousness is not made of separate parts, but **flows like a stream**





Pop-Up Quiz

What's the function of fear?

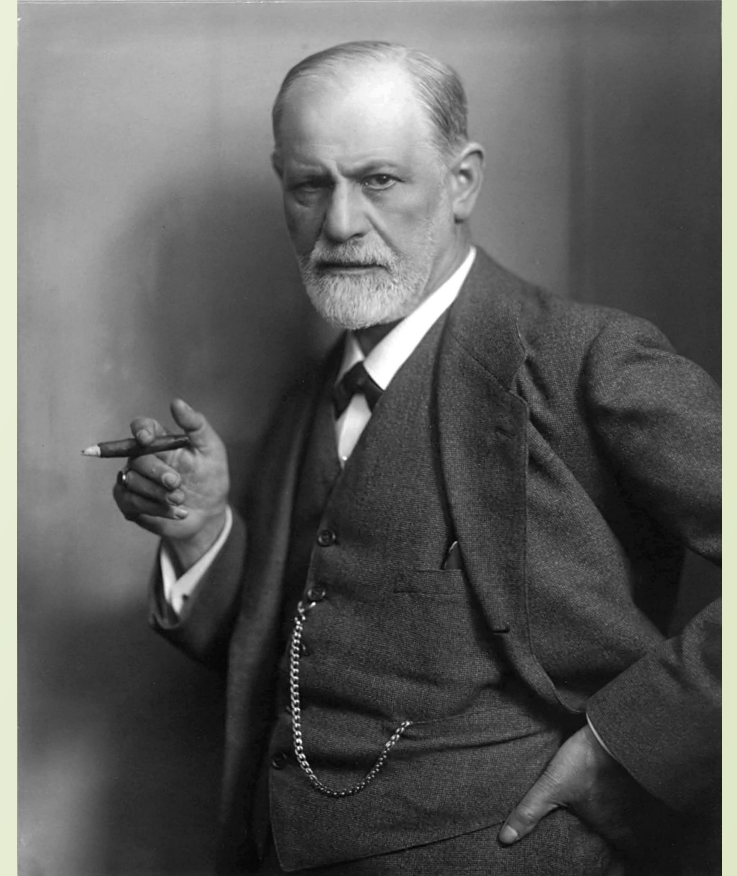
- A. Scare people
- B. Make Fun
- C. Survival

What's the function of anger?

- D. Promote Hate Crimes
- E. Discharge of Difficult Emotion
- F. Indicate the Moral Code in Human

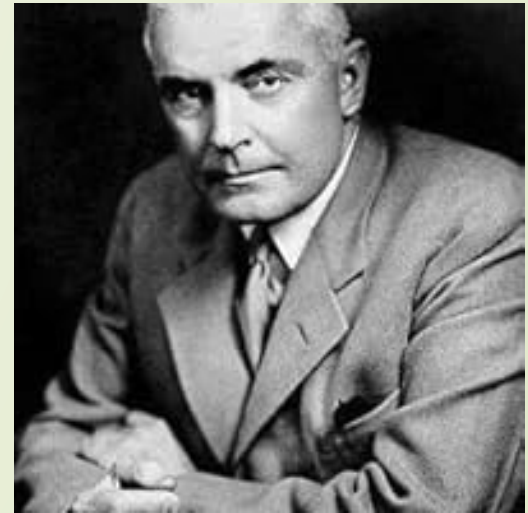
Sigmund Freud: Psychoanalysis

- ❑ Sigmund Freud argued that human behavior is largely influenced by **unconscious mental processes** that operate outside of our awareness.
- ❑ The unconscious mind contains uncomfortable, painful, or socially unacceptable thoughts, emotions, memories, and desires (jealousy, repressed sexual desires).
- ❑ Freud believed that although we are not aware of these hidden processes, they strongly influence our **personality, relationships, dreams, and everyday behavior**.



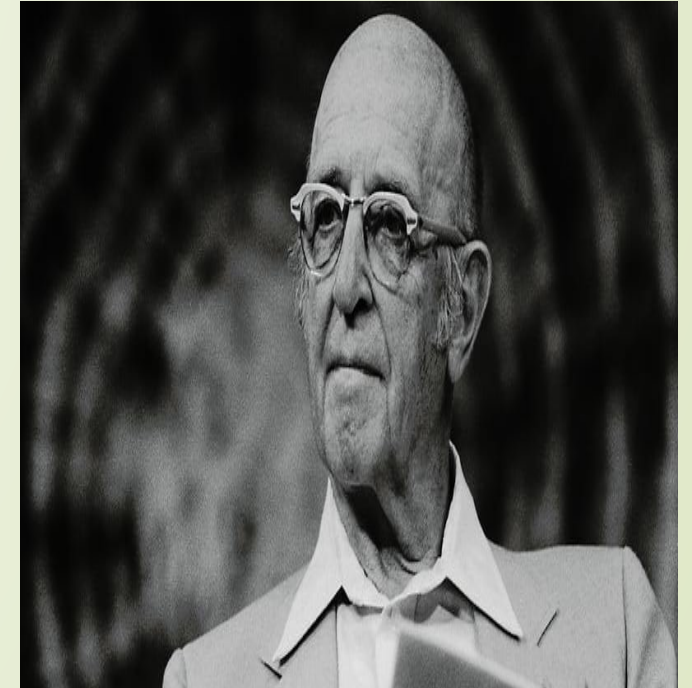
John B Watson: Behaviorism

- **John Watson (and B. F. Skinner)** argued that psychology should study only **observable and measurable behavior**, not thoughts, feelings, or inner experiences
- One of the basic principle is “Every Behavior is Learned”! most human behavior is **learned from the environment** through processes such as **association, rewards, and punishments**.



Carl Rogers: Humanistic Psychology

- ❑ Carl Rogers (and Abraham Maslow), claimed all people naturally strive for **personal growth, meaning, and self-fulfillment**.
- ❑ Humanistic psychologists believe that people have **free-will; ability to choose, grow, and become our best selves**.
- ❑ They argued that psychology should focus on the positive potential of human beings, not just on problems or disorders.

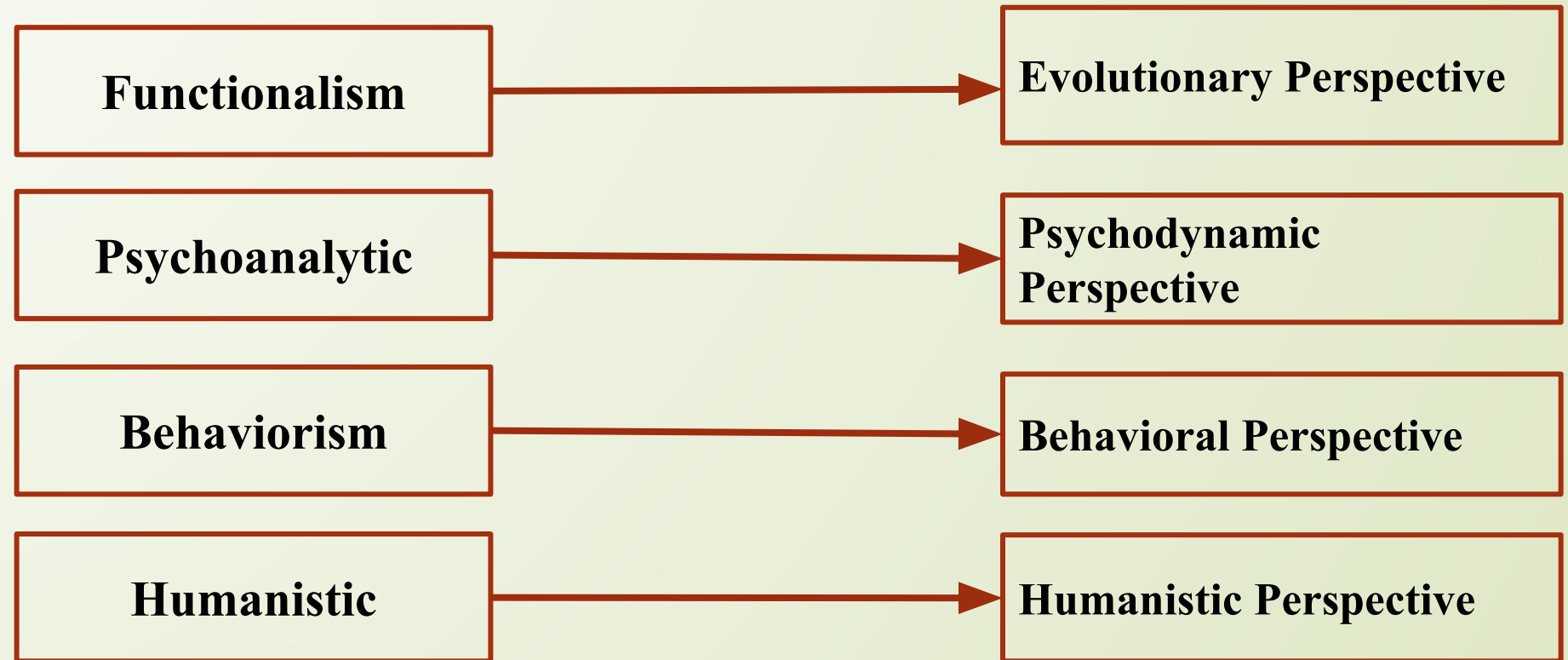




Schools Evolving to Perspectives

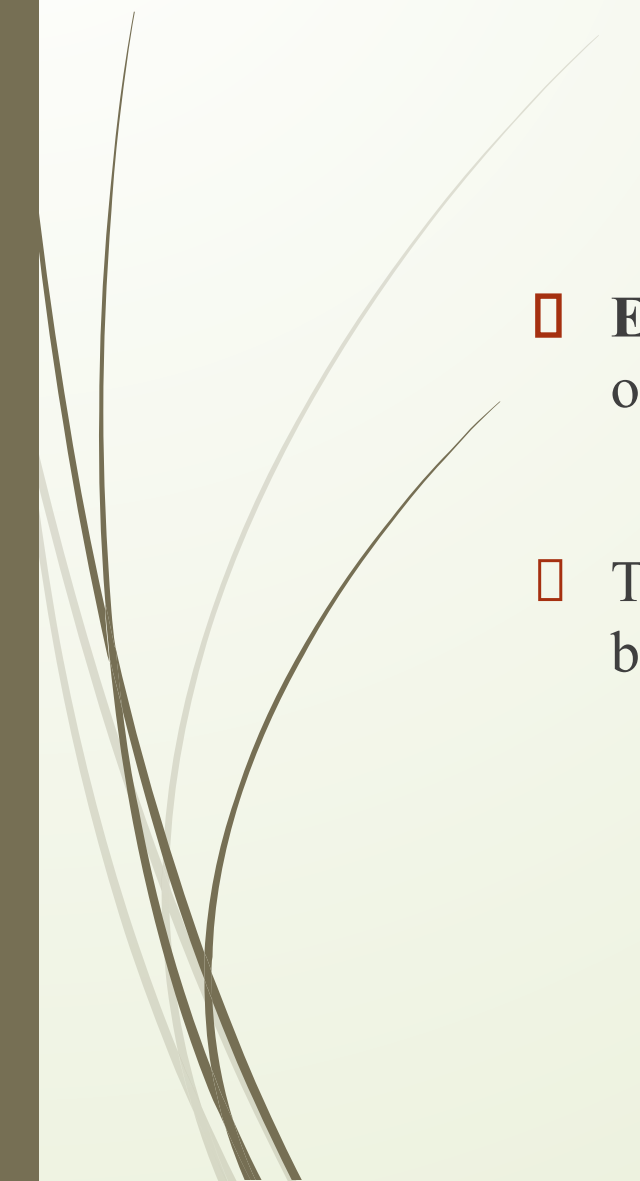
Historical Schools Have Evolved into Modern Perspectives!

- Perspectives are conceptual lens derived from historical schools to understand human behaviors.





Evolutionary Perspective



- ❑ **Evolutionary Perspective** focuses on how does natural selection of traits promotes survival of the genes
- ❑ The central question is “How does evolution affects/influences behavioral tendencies”



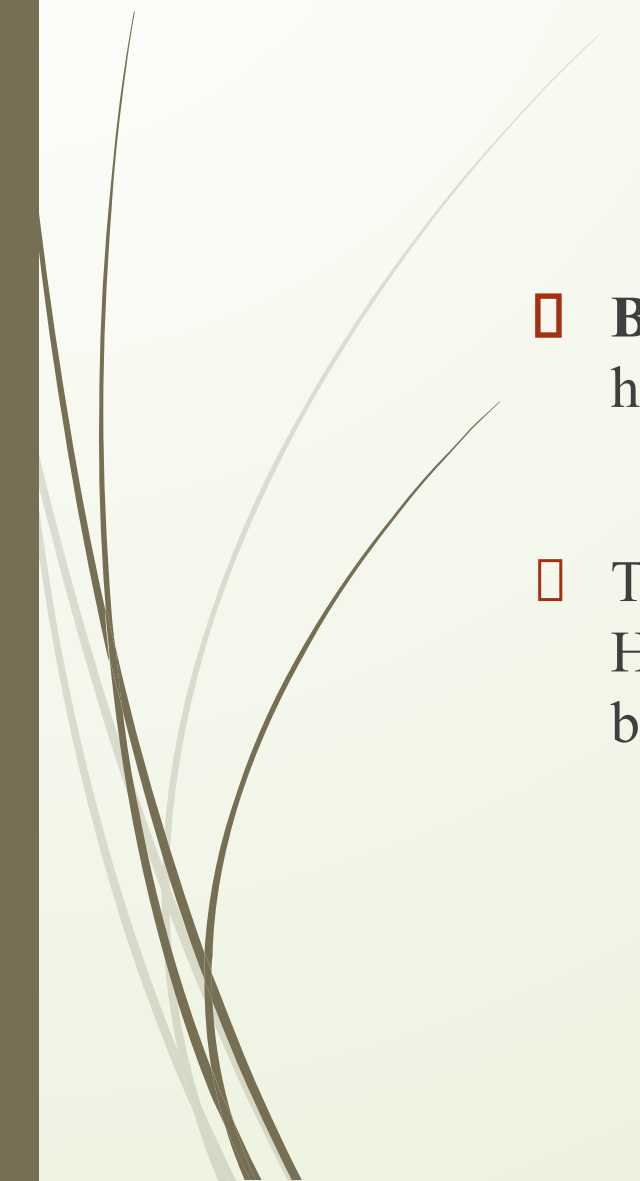
Psychodynamic Perspective



- ❑ **Psychodynamic Perspective** focuses on how behavior is shaped by unconscious drives and forces.
- ❑ The central question is “How someone’s personality trait and disorders can be explained through unconscious sexual and aggression drives or as a disguised affect of unfulfilled desires or childhood trauma”



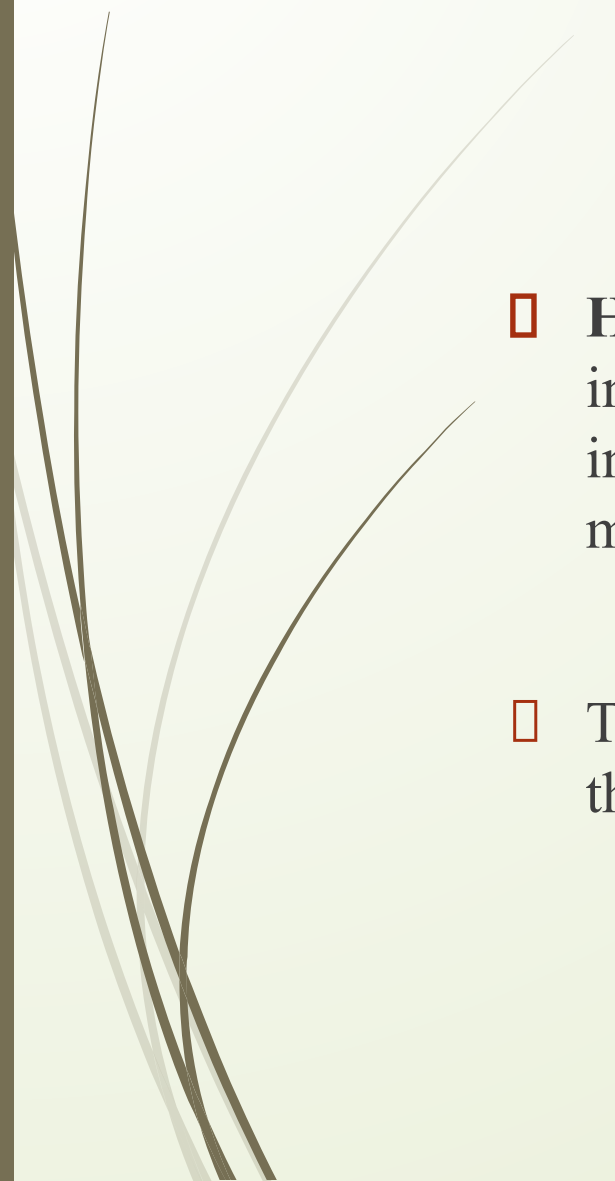
Behavioral Perspective



- **Behavioral Perspective** focuses on how behavior is learned and how it can be altered, observed and measured.
- The central question is “How we learn to behave in a certain way? How can behaviors be effectively altered for promoting adaptive behaviors and discarding maladaptive behaviors?”



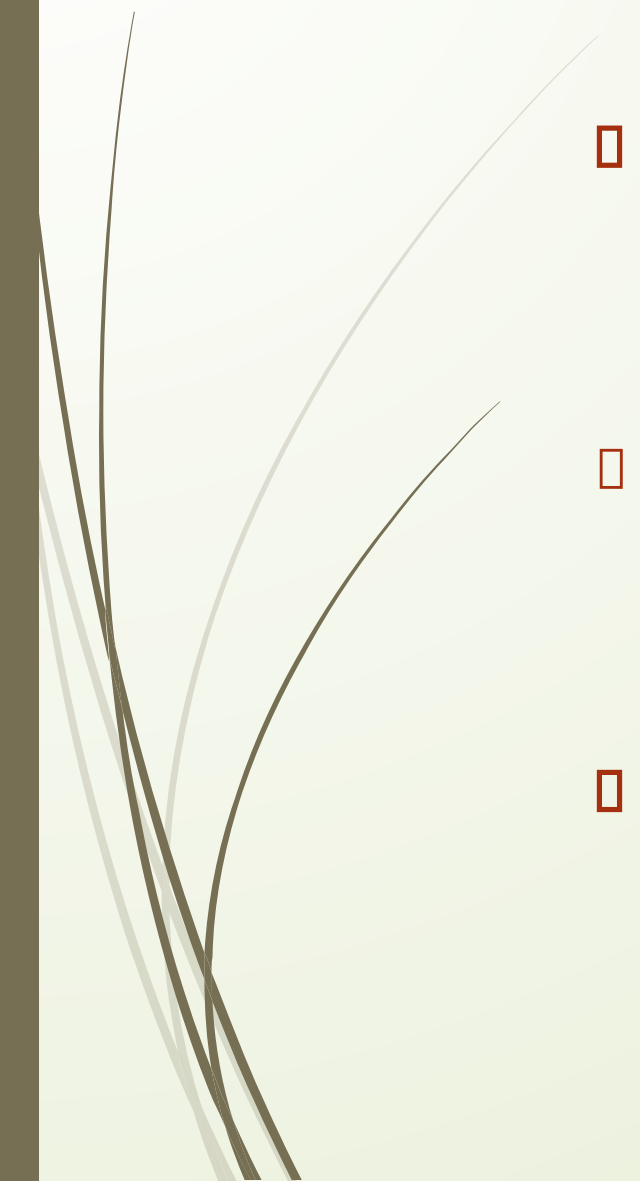
Humanistic Perspective



- ❑ **Humanistic Perspective** focuses on how individual strives for innate personal growth and quest self-worth. It also emphasizes on individual's free will directed towards the search for the true meaning of life.
- ❑ The central question is “How individual can realize and identify their true potential and actual meaning of life?”



Modern Perspectives



❑ Neuropsychological Perspective:

- ❑ Explains behavior by focusing on **the brain, nervous system, hormones, and genes**. Emotions are connected to brain activity and chemical signals.

❑ Cognitive Perspectives:

- ❑ Focuses on how people **think, interpret** situations, **remember** events, and make decisions. It suggests that behaviors and emotions depends on how we make sense of the world around us.

❑ Socio-cultural Perspective:

- ❑ Focuses on how **culture, social rules, group norms**, and relationships shape behavior.

Explain this Aggression from Different Perspectives



Describe the picture from Evolutionary Perspective

Describe the picture from Neuropsychological Perspective

Describe the picture from Psychodynamic Perspective

Describe the picture from Humanistic Perspective

Explain this Cheating Behavior from Different Perspective



Describe the picture from Humanistic Perspective

Describe the picture from Behavioral Perspective

Describe the picture from Cognitive Perspective

Describe the picture from Psychodynamic Perspective



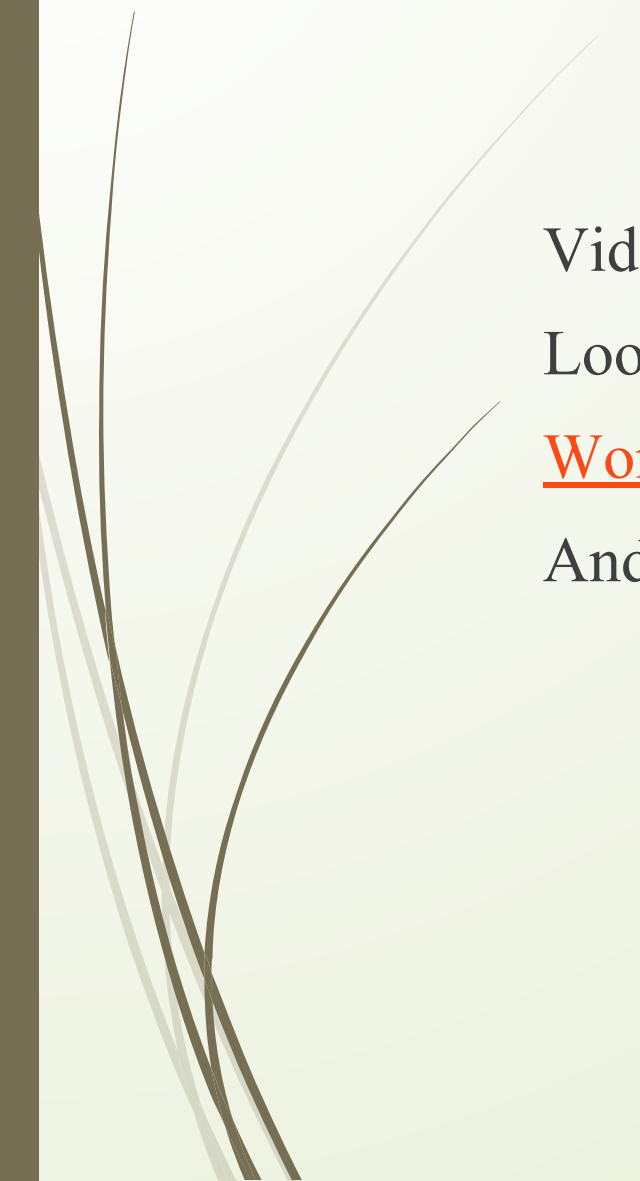
Women in Psychology

Video Presentation

Look at the following video

[Women In Psychology](#)

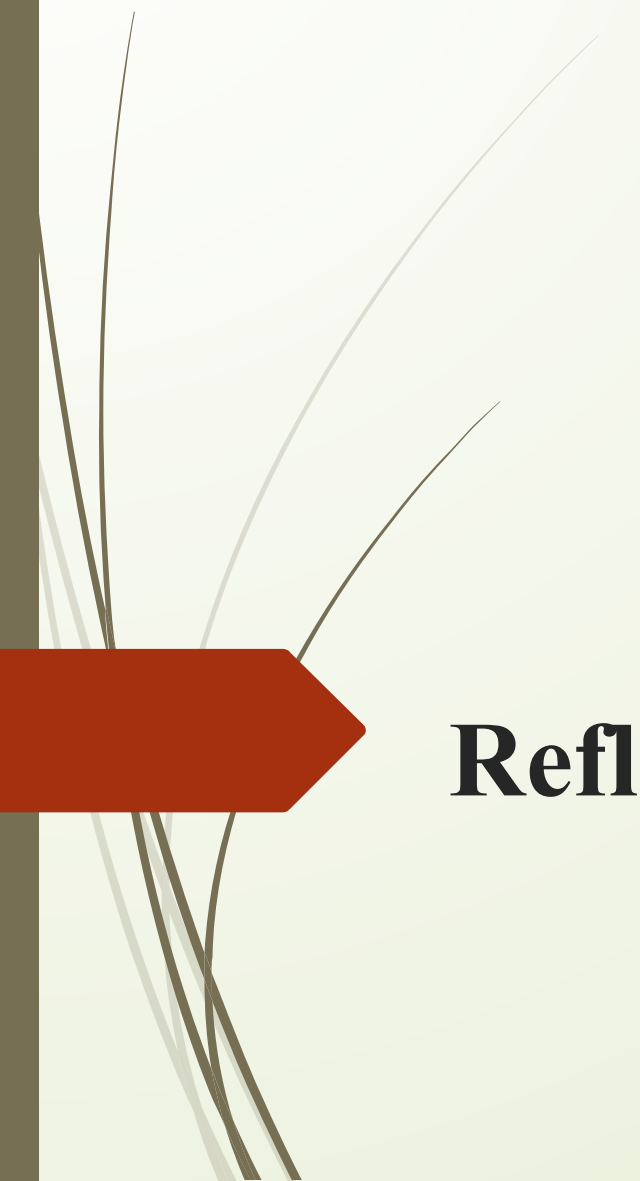
And try to answer the given questions





Psychology is Everywhere!

- There are multiple sub-fields of psychology in modern days!
 - **Clinical/Counseling Psychology:** Assessment and Management of Mental Health Problems, life problems and adjustment
 - **Educational Psychology:** How Teaching and Learning can be improved
 - **Social Psychology:** How people's thoughts, feelings, and behaviors are influenced by others and by social situations
 - **Developmental Psychology:** Human development across the lifespan
 - **Neuropsychology:** Deeper study Brain and behavior
 - **Industrial–Organizational Psychology:** Workplace behavior and performance
 - **Health Psychology:** Psychological factors in health and illness
 - **Forensic Psychology:** Psychology in legal and criminal contexts



Reflection and Take-home Message